



Use AI to help you ask more effective questions

Great data analysis starts with great questions. Before you can answer questions with data, you need to know what you're asking. Only then can you unlock actionable insights and smarter decisions. At the end of the day, the data reports we create as analysts are supposed to help drive decisions. That means the questions we ask ahead of time greatly impact what can be answered with our reports. As you've probably guessed, gen AI tools can help with this important task of defining the right questions, precise, relevant, actionable questions for effective data analysis. Let's go through an example.

Suppose we're data analysts working together for a retailer, and we're trying to figure out how to improve the customer experience. I might write a prompt like, I was given access to a comprehensive data set for an online retailer that includes customer demographics, purchase history, and website interaction logs. What are the key questions I should formulate to guide an analysis aimed at improving customer experience and increasing sales? Describe the steps to define and prioritize these questions. Ah, here we go. I get a list of potential questions to ask about my dataset, as well as what I can do to start answering them. And here's a pro tip.

You can ask the AI tool to rate itself with the output or stack rank the potential questions. It tends to give multiple results, and will scale them based on how well it thinks it did or how easy the questions will lead you to insights. Nice. Ready for something even cooler? As a data analyst, there are more advanced tools, some of them paid, that let you do even more things with your data. In my job, I use Gemini Advance to connect data sources directly to the model. Instead of me clicking around in my data, hoping to

find a trend that stands out to me, Gemini analyzes the data I present, and with a couple of questions, it can highlight major trends and patterns, saving me a lot of time.

From this summary, I can start formulating deeper analysis, which gives me an extra boost in productivity. Defining good questions is critical for successful data analysis. AI can help you streamline this process so that your questions are precise, relevant, and actionable. This will enhance your analysis and lead to deeper insights and better decision making. Now, try applying these techniques to your data.